



annual membership," says Karan.

The boats in the Privada stable have been handpicked for the marine enthusiast. While the Azimut is all about luxurious indulgence and meant for big groups, the Cabrio is more of a sporty coastal cruiser. These boats cater to clients across the board—party people, corporates and families. The price tag for this smooth surfing lifestyle rests in the price range of Rs 15 lakh to Rs 30 lakh for a three-year membership, which involves 30 sailing days on an Azimut and 39 days on the Cabrio. And with sailing season extending from October to May, members



RAJESH KHATWANI,
MUMBAI-BASED INDUSTRIALIST

"Clubs like these will give Indians a taste of what they have been missing out on till date."

can look forward to eight months of clear skies and favourable winds.

If you harbour dreams of spotting dolphins at Uran, exploring Maharashtra's coastline and enjoying a barbecue or two on a deserted beach, here's a steal of a deal, claims Mumbai-based industrialist Rajesh Khatwani. He recently celebrated his birthday on board the ultra luxurious Azimut, and is now a certified cruise addict. "It was a unique experience aboard the Azimut, which is a Lamborghini among yachts. It's like driving an ordinary car versus cruising in a Maybach," says Khatwani, adding that the arrangement works perfectly for him as Privada handles all his stress and he gets to entertain friends on an impressive yacht. "This will give Indians a taste of what they've been missing out on till date," he says.

Many believe that this, in turn, will aid the development of the boating industry. Says Malav Shroff, former Olympian and director of the Mumbai International Boat Show, "Club Privada has introduced something that already exists in the international luxury segment. This is a big step for India's fledgling boating industry. In the next season, they may introduce almost 1,000 people to water." Boating enthusiasts are hoping that the increase in demand will also aid the development of infrastructure. "Clubs generally have a captive audience and these are the places where infrastructure growth will start," hopes Shroff.

And this just seems to be the first wave. Club Privada plans to pump in Rs 100 crore over the next three years and diversify its fleet with specialised fishing boats, sports boats, party boats and house boats, among others, hoping to "grow with the clientele and their interests". Karan says that fractional ownership schemes may also be initiated at a later stage. With a discreet list of industrialists, builders, hoteliers and bankers lining up for a chance on deck, inquiries pouring in from Goa and Cochin, and plans of a possible tie-up with international yachting clubs to share vacation time, it looks like Club Privada is prepped for a long-haul voyage. Get set to sail in style. ■